

SURESH M.

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Drupal Developer with 10+ years of overall web application development experience. Extensive hands-on experience with Drupal 9/10, including custom module creation and third-party API integration, with additional delivery experience on Drupal 8 and 11 across enterprise, sports, and B2B platforms. Proven track record leading decoupled/headless Drupal architecture on Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), custom content-entity development, API integrations, and CI/CD automation with Docker and Kubernetes. Strong background in PHP MVC frameworks — Laravel and CakePHP — for REST-API-driven mobile backends. Adopts AI-augmented development practices (Claude) alongside DDEV and Postman to accelerate debugging, code modernization, and documentation. Recognized as a technical project lead for client requirement analysis, solution estimation, security hardening, and mentoring junior developers. Comfortable operating across the full SDLC in Agile/JIRA-driven environments.

CORE TECHNICAL SKILLS

CMS & Frameworks: Drupal 9, 10 (custom module creation & third-party API integration), Drupal 10, 11 (Decoupled/Headless), Drupal Migrations (D8 to D9, D9 to D10, D10 to D11), PHP 7/8 (PHP 8.3)

Languages & Front-End: PHP, MySQL, JavaScript, jQuery, HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap, Twig templating, AJAX, JSON

Drupal Architecture: Custom Module & Plugin Development (Drupal 9/10), Custom Content Entities, Views & Contextual Filters, Single Directory Components (SDC), Group Module (multi-competition/multi-tenant structure), Panels/Page Manager, hook system & execution ordering, custom theming

APIs & Integrations: Third-Party API Integration, REST API & JSON:API design, Simple OAuth / JWT, OpenID Connect, SSO, Azure Active Directory, Stripe, Braintree, Firebase Push Notifications, Google reCAPTCHA, Google Analytics/GTM/GA4, Google Maps & Distance Matrix API, Twilio, Bullhorn API, AWS API, Wistia API, Acuity Scheduling API

Cloud, DevOps & Infrastructure: Azure DevOps, Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), Docker, Kubernetes manifests (PVC, liveness/readiness probes, PodDisruptionBudget), Azure Pipelines CI/CD, Nginx & PHP-FPM tuning, Cloudflare caching, Git/GitHub, Acquia Cloud

Developer Tools & Environment: DDEV (local development environment), Postman (API design, testing & documentation)

AI-Augmented Development: Uses Claude (Anthropic) as part of the development workflow for code review, debugging assistance, code modernization, and technical documentation

Practices: Agile/Scrum, JIRA ticket & sprint management, technical leadership, client requirement analysis & estimation, POC development, mentoring & knowledge transfer, multilingual (Arabic RTL/English) delivery

Framework: Laravel 5.8 (PHP MVC framework), CakePHP 3.4/3.5

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Drupal Developer — Project Lead | Appstation Pvt Ltd, Thiruvananthapuram, India
2024 – Present | Drupal 10/11, PHP 8.3, Azure AKS, Docker, Laravel (Match Center API), MySQL

Qatar Stars League (QSL) — qsl.qa — Decoupled Drupal 11 platform on Azure Kubernetes Service

- **Lead custom module creation and third-party API integration** for a decoupled Drupal 10/11 platform serving five concurrent competitions (Doha Stars League, QSL Cup, Qatar Cup, Doha Cup, EQSL) using a single-site Group module architecture, plus a mobile app backend.
- **Implemented Simple OAuth/JWT-secured REST and JSON:API endpoints** powering the decoupled front-end and native mobile applications, alongside Firebase push notifications and SSO.
- **Restructured 4 high-traffic pages** (Standings, Fixtures, Top Scorers, Archive) from controller-based rendering to Views + Single Directory Components (SDC) for maintainability and performance.
- **Handled Docker end-to-end** for the platform — building and maintaining application images, managing containers for local DDEV-based development, and supporting containerized deployment and troubleshooting on AKS.
- Used Kubernetes and Docker containers for staging and production access and deployment of the application on AKS.
- **Diagnosed and resolved production caching and analytics issues**, including Cloudflare/Drupal cache-header conflicts and GTM/GA4 tracking misconfigurations, to restore accurate analytics reporting.
- **Delivered full bilingual (Arabic RTL / English) support** across the custom theme (qsl) and Twig templates for the Middle East market.

- **Coordinated Match Center integration architecture** with a Laravel-based match data API, estimating cross-team (Drupal, Laravel, mobile) efforts and dependencies.

career.qsl.qa — *QSL Multi-Site Application — Career Portal*

- **Established career.qsl.qa** as a multi-site Drupal application belonging to the QSL platform, dedicated to hosting career opportunities for the organization.
- **Enabled job managers to publish job openings** with configurable visibility, keeping each listing live and open for applications only for a defined period before automatic expiry.

Lusail (LCSC) — lcsc.qa — *Project Lead*

- Analyzed client requirements and produced project estimations for a custom Drupal build.
- Delivered custom theme and template integration matched to design specifications.
- Engineered custom Drupal modules to support project-specific functionality.

Associate Consultant | Tata Consultancy Services (TCS), Chennai, India

May 2023 – Nov 2023 | Drupal 8/9, Git, Acquia Cloud

Johnson & Johnson — Technical Support & Site Maintenance

- Led and managed Drupal application support for client Johnson & Johnson, ensuring on-time, quality-assured delivery.
- Diagnosed and resolved production issues across Drupal CMS, modules, themes, and integrations by analyzing logs and system behavior to identify root causes.
- Configured Drupal sites, modules, permissions, workflows, and content structures to match evolving business requirements.
- Performed routine core/module/theme updates on Acquia Cloud to apply security patches, bug fixes, and performance improvements.
- Monitored system performance, resource utilization, and uptime to proactively surface potential issues.
- Managed JIRA tickets, scheduled and assigned tasks to junior developers, and mentored the team on Drupal best practices.
- Maintained up-to-date technical documentation of project processes and specifications.

Senior Analyst Programmer | Unimetry Solution Pvt Ltd, Chennai, India

Jul 2021 – Apr 2023 | Drupal 8/9, PHP, MySQL, Azure AD, OAuth

Coin — *Drupal 9.4.8, HTML, CSS, PHP, MySQL*

- Established a group-authoring content management system with role-based access for higher-level group members, including invite/join workflows.
- Configured SMTP for transactional email and implemented Redis caching to improve response times.
- Used Panels and Page Manager for flexible page creation and admin-level configuration.
- Extended the custom authoring module and resolved content-type validation bugs across the platform.

Crypta — *Drupal 9.3, HTML, CSS, PHP, MySQL*

- Delivered third-party API integration with Azure Active Directory and OAuth to secure authentication and resource access for group-based users.
- Designed a custom service API to pull document data from an Azure AD-backed O365 module into content types, with a companion directory API for permissioned access.
- Led the Drupal 8-to-9 migration and module version upgrade for the project.
- Resolved content-type validation bugs and extended access-control logic for the platform.

Engagez (BMC) — *Drupal 8, HTML, CSS, PHP, MySQL, jQuery*

- Delivered a virtual events, expos, and conference-hosting platform using PHP and Drupal.
- Created a custom module to integrate a third-party Avatar API, retrieving and maintaining avatar data via cURL-based service calls.

Senior PHP Developer | Farshore Software Development Pvt Ltd, Madurai, Tamil Nadu, India

Oct 2015 – Jul 2021 | PHP 5.4, Laravel 5.8, CakePHP 3.4/3.5, MySQL, REST API

- Delivered 7 client projects end-to-end across Laravel and CakePHP stacks, from mobile-app backends to payment- and geolocation-integrated web platforms.

Stepaway — *Laravel 5.8, HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap, jQuery, REST API*

- Engineered the Laravel-based backend and REST APIs for Stepaway, a companion iOS/Android app supporting users through alcohol-addiction recovery.
- Designed backend logic to deliver personalized recovery tools, proven strategies, and progress-tracking content to the mobile app.
- Implemented feedback and milestone-tracking features so users could monitor their recovery progress over time.
- Collaborated with the mobile team to design and expose REST endpoints consumed by the native iOS and Android clients.

Oviesmaterwave — *Laravel 5.8, HTML5, CSS3, Bootstrap, jQuery, REST API*

- Built the Laravel-based backend and companion REST APIs for Oviesmaterwave, a smart food-tracking consumer app paired with a physical food tag.
- Wrote API logic to track food status and trigger colour-change/expiry-alert notifications as items approached their expiration date.
- Added recipe-recommendation logic that suggested recipes based on items nearing expiry to help reduce food waste.
- Synchronized data between the physical smart tag, mobile app, and backend to keep freshness status current in real time.

QuickCup — *PHP 5.4, CakePHP 3.4, MySQL, jQuery, Google Map & Distance Matrix API*

- Built the backend for an iOS coffee-ordering app, integrating Google geolocation APIs for nearest-shop discovery and multiple payment options.

PeopleCaddie — *CakePHP 3.5, MySQL, REST API, Google Map API, Bullhorn API*

- Developed REST API and Bullhorn ATS integration for a staffing-marketplace platform connecting contractors with hiring managers.

GetTread — *CakePHP 3.5, MySQL, TireConnect API, ATD API, Stripe Payment*

- Integrated TireConnect and ATD APIs alongside Stripe payments for an on-demand tire ordering and installation-scheduling application.

Tiltas — *PHP 5.4, CakePHP 3.4.7, Twilio API*

- Added Twilio-based click-to-call and SMS messaging functionality inside an admin sales-management panel.

Points — *PHP 5.4, CakePHP 3.4.7, AWS API, Wistia API*

- Launched an online teacher-tutorial platform with Wistia video delivery and quiz-gated progression (80% pass threshold) for learners.

EDUCATION

Master of Engineering (Computer Science) — Muthayammal Engineering College, Anna University, Tamil Nadu, India (2012 – 2014) — CGPA 8.9

Bachelor of Information Technology — SSM College of Engineering, Anna University, Tamil Nadu, India — 73%

CERTIFICATIONS

Drupal Master Class — Build 9 Projects (Drupal 9 Tutorial) — Udemy — *Does not expire* | [View Certificate](#)

Introduction to Cloud Computing on AWS — Udemy | [View Certificate](#)

Foundations of Project Management — Google (Coursera) | [View Certificate](#)

Agile Project Management — Google (Coursera) | [View Certificate](#)

Project Initiation: Starting a Successful Project — Google (Coursera) | [View Certificate](#)